

# Kieron Harding – CV

Location: Basingstoke

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Extensive experience in *Azure, Kubernetes, Elastic, Helm, Terraform* and *CI/CD Pipelines*. Passionate about automation, security and optimising cloud infrastructure for high availability. Experienced in mentoring teams, collaborating with stakeholders and driving automation securely and efficiently.

## Current Role

Senior DevOps Engineer - Matrix Security Watchdog

MARCH 2024 ▶ PRESENT

- **Infrastructure Leadership:** Lead the design, implementation and cost optimisation of our Core Platform infrastructure, with high availability and security by design.
- **Automation & Security:** Spearheaded improvements in our IaC (Infrastructure as Code) processes, Cloud Management and Posture as well as improvements to our Gitlab projects, focusing on scalability, automation and security enhancements.
- **Mentorship & Collaboration:** Mentoring junior engineers in the department and collaborating with Technical Architects and key stakeholders to drive continuous improvement in CI/CD processes.
- **Operational Excellence:** Overseeing our 24x7x365 service availability, ensuring seamless scaling and system robustness during standard operation as well as upgrades in Production.

## Previous Roles

DevOps Engineer - Matrix Security Watchdog

NOVEMBER 2020 ▶ MARCH 2024

- Driven infrastructure improvements using Terraform, Kubernetes, Azure and Gitlab to ensure and deliver a highly available and performant 24x7x365 system.
- Optimised our CI/CD pipelines, reducing deployment times into Production by 65% and increasing efficiency during upgrades.
- Enhanced security measures across our cloud infrastructure by implementing automated patching to reduce vulnerability lifetime windows by 90%.

Digital Solutions Consultant - Security Watchdog  
2020

FEBRUARY 2019 ▶ NOVEMBER

- Led the implementation of Azure Sentinel, still in Preview, strengthening our cloud security posture and achieving greater visibility across our estate.
- Managed a telephony migration project, improving operational efficiency.
- Collaborated with Microsoft to resolve business-critical issues.
- Supported InfoSec Teams in compliance and policy enforcement.

# Key Projects

## Core Platform Continuous Improvement

- Leveraged Terraform to strengthen and improve the Core Platform's infrastructure.
- Enabled rapid iteration and deployment into Production, reducing time to market for new features and security improvements.
- Ensured scalability and resilience, continuously optimising cloud resources for performance as well as cost efficiency.

## Cloud Cost Optimisation Initiative

- Implemented auto-scaling into our clusters, using various data points to define scale activity, reducing cloud spend by 30%.
- Migrating workloads from classical deployments to optimised Kubernetes clusters, improving efficiency.

## Security & Compliance Overhaul

- Automated security patching across multiple kinds of resources using Terraform to strengthen and improve our infrastructure posture.
- Enabled rapid iteration and deployment into Production, reducing time-to-market for new features and improvements.
- Ensured scalability and resilience, continuously optimising cloud resources for performance and cost efficiency.

## Skills and abilities

- **Programming:** Python, Terraform, bash (focused on automation & infrastructure as code).
- **Cloud Infrastructure:** Extensive experience with Azure, managing web apps, Linux VMs, and cloud security.
- **DevOps & Automation:** Expertise in Terraform, Kubernetes, GitLab, and CI/CD pipelines.
- **Database Management:** Proficient in SQL, including query optimization and database modifications.
- **Monitoring & Logging:** Experience with Prometheus, Grafana, and ELK Stack.
- **Security & Compliance:** Strong knowledge of Azure Sentinel, DevSecOps best practices, and InfoSec policies.